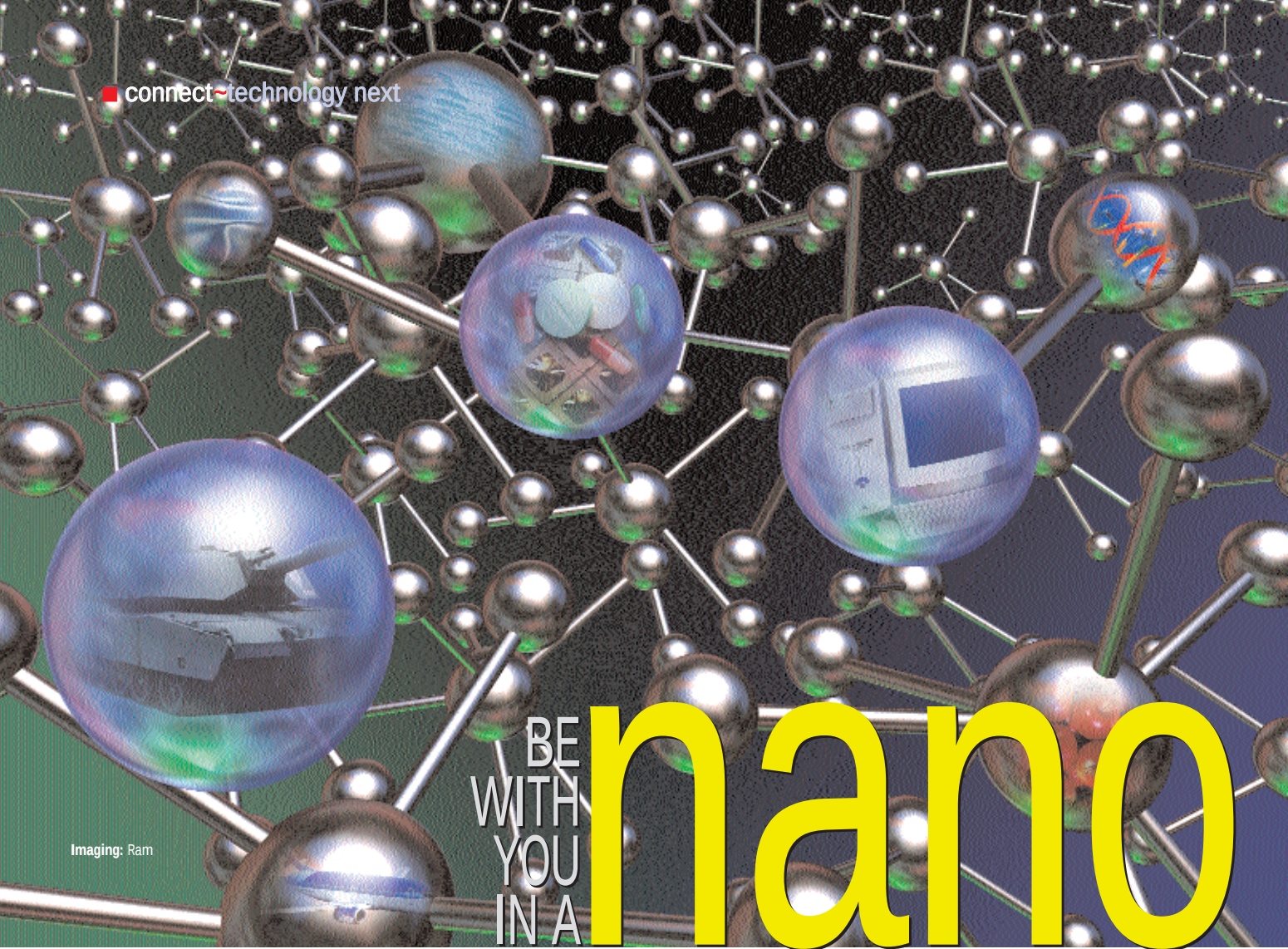




Imaging: Ram

BE WITH YOU IN A nano

The industrial revolution, electricity, airplanes, computers, nuclear power, the Internet and now the next big thing: Nanotechnology. Get ready for the atomic world

ANIL PATRICK R.

It would help if you've seen the movie *Inner Space*. Try imagining a small doctor travelling inside your body fixing up whatever's wrong. Or envisage yourself stuck in a traffic jam and being guided by the computers in your shirt's threads to a clear road. Or alternatively, think of chameleon-like soldiers blending in perfectly with their surroundings and sensing all oncoming attacks. All these are not mere imagination—they would be realities in the brave new world of Nanotechnology, a technology that would usher in this and so many more things we haven't even dreamed of. All this is going to happen sooner than we expect.

Nanotechnology, which deals with matter at atomic levels, is not just restricted to the field of medicine. In fact, it will change almost

everything we are used to—right from the roads we walk every evening to the food we eat every day and down to the clothes that we wear.

Nanotechnology puts the power of creation into human hands. But contrary to popular perception, the immediate goals of Nanotechnology are not to further life and conquer death. It is more of a quest for discovering nanostructures that may have excellent electrical, chemical, mechanical or optical properties. Don't wonder too hard about what it is. Come take a look.

Small, smaller, smallest...

When we think of small things, there is a limit to how small we can think. A speck of dust or maybe particles, which can be seen only with a magnifying lens. This is where Nanotechnology differs. It deals with the most basic building

Designed for the senses.
Engineered for the intellect...

